

DAVIDE DANTONIO

Innovation Economy · Director of Accelerator Programs · gener8tor · Indianapolis

INNOVATION ECONOMY OPERATOR · PRE-SEED AND SEED FOUNDER COACH

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- Innovation-Economy operator sourcing, vetting, coaching, and structuring capital for the best and most diverse pre-Seed and Seed founders, sole director of 10 accelerator cohorts across the US and Italy.
- Plugged into a working network of 250+ mentors and 200+ investors that turns coachable founders into named, real-world outcomes.

SECTION 1 · THE STARTUP PORTFOLIO I DIRECTLY COACHED

Coached 52 founders across 10 cohorts · raised \$7.84M total capital (\$5.43M dilutive equity + \$2.42M non-dilutive grants & state incentives) · 60+ curated investor introductions per founder · 220 US jobs created.

\$7.84M CAPITAL RAISED	52 FOUNDERS COACHED	10 COHORTS DIRECTED	220 US JOBS CREATED	86 AVG FOUNDER NPS
SOURCE OF THE \$7.84M				
\$5.43M Dilutive Equity Raised Institutional investors, milestones-driven capital plans, 60+ curated investor introductions per founder.			\$2.42M Non-Dilutive Capital Federal grants (US National Science Foundation), state incentive packages (Indiana economic development), authored commercialization strategies.	
► INDUSTRY BREADTH, 52 COMPANIES ACROSS 9 SECTORS (★ FEATURED OUTCOME BELOW)				
12	Artificial Intelligence & Enterprise Software	Desync.ai · Dapto · HUMN Capital · Second Opinion · PaveX ★ · Pumpkin AI · Authentic Ink · Motoring Labs · Human Singularity · DiversiFind · ITER IDEA · Allira Systems		
7	FinTech, InsurTech & Blockchain	Guama ★ · VitalSwap · ONOW Ascent · PoliStock · DigsFact · Prospect XR · Timbucktoo		
4	HealthTech & Wellness	Home Health Pro · Theraproove ★ · RiteCarbs · OVUE		
8	Climate, AgTech & Sustainability	Aropha ★ · AgroNet ZERO · ArborMapper · BioFique · NourishFlow Dynamics · Terroir from Space · JUA Technologies · rScan ★		
5	Energy & CleanTech	Voltest · Novac ★ · Animo Technologies · Diamond Power · Kronfeld Motor		
5	Industrial 4.0, Robotics & Advanced Manufacturing	GEKOT Robotics · WPR Services · Zemike Precision Optics · Fitasy · Electric Vehicle Gear		
5	SpaceTech & Aerospace	Involve Space · REA Space · O-Boot · X-ENDER Space · Intuos		
3	Cybersecurity & Defense	Covert Defenses ★ · Wolfberry · XPHERA ★		
3	Gaming, Sports & Immersive Media	Feenix Sport ★ · Vertikal X ★ · Dellstar VR		

► SOME OF THE GREAT ACHIEVEMENTS FROM FOUNDERS I HELPED SCALE

Vertikal X, Feenix Group, ITER Idea	International · SportTech, Media, SaaS	US relocation + state backing + VC raises	Vertikal X relocated its US headquarters from Austin to Indianapolis via my intros (Mayor Hogsett + Indiana economic-development endorsement); Feenix Group relocated to Indiana, made its first US hires, and raised from US investors with my support; ITER Idea (Italy) commercializing in the US market
rScan	Commerce, Supply Chain	Startup of the Year, TechPoint 2025 Mira	\$1.2M Indiana state tax credits, 152 Indiana jobs committed by 2028; headquarters expansion 15K → 53K sq ft; founder named to TechPoint Tech 25
Guama (Colombia)	FinTech / Credit Access	\$1.5M seed + 6,000+ customers	Salkantay, Hustle Fund, Story Ventures, Techstars; 75K+ credit apps (60% no prior credit history) vs Bancolombia/BBVA; Forbes Colombia 100 Startups
Aropha (Cleveland)	AgBio AI / Biodegradation	\$1M institutional seed	Comeback Capital, Lighthank, Right Side Capital; founder to Forbes Cleveland 30 Under 30; launched Biodegradation Studio AI (May 2025)
Covert Defense (Purdue)	Cybersecurity / Energy	\$1M Department of Homeland Security contract + \$1M+ NSF	Authored commercialization strategy; Department of Energy Phase II federal innovation grant; multi-state expansion (Indiana, Kentucky, Tennessee); 2 – 5 full-time hires in 3 months
XPhera	GovTech / Geo-positioning	\$500K client pipeline + \$100K+ airport contract	Built a \$500K client pipeline by connecting the CEO with a VP-of-Sales hire and installing sales frameworks (MEDDPIC, SPIN, client ROI calculators); renewed a \$100K+ contract with the Indianapolis Airport
Motoring Labs, Timbucktoo, Voltest	Logistics CV, Blockchain, Battery	Into nationally-ranked accelerators post-gBETA	After gBETA, accepted into top accelerators: Timbucktoo into Andreessen Horowitz (a16z) TxO; Voltest into Techstars; Motoring Labs into the gener8tor investment accelerator
Novac (Italy)	SpaceTech / Supercapacitors	€3.5M seed (~\$4.37M)	CDP Venture Capital, Eureka! Venture, Galaxia; all 4 co-founders to Forbes Italia Under 30 (2024); Dallara IndyCar partnership; European Space Agency incubator in Turin

► MY FOUNDERS SCALING STEPS, BY STAGE

A · CUSTOMER PERSONA Problem-Solution Fit	B · CUSTOMER BUYING DECISION Product-Market Fit	C · CUSTOMER JOURNEY Go-to-Market	D · CUSTOMER ECONOMICS Fundraising
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► FOUNDERS SALES FOUNDATIONS · 7-WEEK SALES CHALLENGE

WEEK 1 Ideal-customer profile + persona definition	WEEK 2 Customer-discovery interviews (Mom Test, Pain Funnel)	WEEK 3 Sales-pitch craft + ROI case studies	WEEK 4 Cold-calling practice + objection-handling library	WEEK 5 Pipeline build + qualification (MEDDPIC, SPIN)	WEEK 6 Demos, follow-ups & negotiation tactics	WEEK 7 Close, expansion & customer-economics review
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► FOUNDER NET PROMOTER SCORE (NPS), WOULD FOUNDERS RECOMMEND THE PROGRAM? SCALE -100 TO +100

gBETA Cohorts run by Davide		86
Y Combinator		60
Techstars		40
Industry Avg		38

SECTION 2 · MY NETWORK IN THE VENTURE ECOSYSTEM

Built a network of 250+ mentors + 200+ investors from past programs · judged 10+ startupcompetitions · selected to deliver workshops & mentoring at 20+ universities and ecosystem-support organizations.

250+ MENTORS IN MY NETWORK	200+ INVESTORS IN MY NETWORK	10+ STARTUP COMPETITIONS JUDGED	20+ UNIVERSITIES & ECOSYSTEM-SUPPORT ORGS
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► PRESS, AWARDS & PUBLIC VALIDATION

 TECHPOINT · APR 2025 Two Founders' Journeys in gBETA Indiana 4.0 techpoint.org	 LINKEDIN · SIGNED 25+ founder recommendations linkedin.com/in/davide-dantonio	 IBJ · AWARD Recognition for the Indiana accelerator cohorts Certificate (PDF)	 YOUTUBE · WORKSHOPS Customer Discovery · How to Pitch · Market Sizing youtube.com/@davide-dantonio
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► WORKSHOPS I'VE DELIVERED

Customer Discovery seminar	<i>GrowCo · South Carolina</i>	International Founders Playbook	<i>Born Global · Houston</i>	Market Sizing & Competition	<i>gener8tor · North Carolina</i>	How to Pitch	<i>gener8tor · Wisconsin</i>
Design Thinking basics	<i>USC Freshmen · Columbia, SC</i>	Demand-Supply for Product-Market Fit	<i>Entrepreneur-in-Residence · Michigan</i>	Riskiest-Assumption Testing	<i>Venture For America Fellows</i>		

► ADVISOR · JUDGE · MENTOR, 27 ORGANIZATIONS + 4 STARTUPS ADVISED BEYOND GENER8TOR

■ ADVISOR ■ JUDGE ■ MENTOR

Born Global	Indiana Hardtech	Rally Conf 2025	Rally Conf 2024	Venture Club of IN	Global Entrepreneur-in-Residence Network	McNair Institute · USC
McCluskey · ND	Mogimix · CMU	SaaStock Austin 2025	Moonshot · Purdue	New Venture Challenge	MIT Enterprise Forum	Go Global World Sharks
Indiana DECA	Crossroads · The Mill	Pitch Mayhem	Entrepreneur-in-Residence Vetting Committee	Purdue Innovates	NSF I-Corps	VillageCapital
Techstars · Pittsburgh	Notre Dame · Idea Center	STARTedUP Foundation	Zionsville HS	Indiana University	Purdue Pitch · Global Accelerator Network	